roles and skills that may be replaced by automation. For instance, a study on accountants suggests that removing mundane tasks like going through receipts reduces professional skills development. Instead of blindly taking skills away, AI should be limited to factual tasks and not replace interpretative ones. Interviewees expressed concerns about job loss for those with repetitive tasks but also acknowledged that computation could increase the demand for labour. While some may argue for a more reductionist view of the scientific enterprise, it is important to recognize the value of science, knowledge, and discovery beyond metrics and tasks. Anticipatory governance is needed to ensure that AI implementation within professional roles is approached with foresight and engagement at all levels.

The impact of AI tools on scientific research is already significant. AI presents opportunities for change in areas where change is needed, while also providing stability for entrenched habits. Similar to the debate on responsible metrics in research, there is a need for the responsible application of AI strategies. The wider discussion on metrics can provide useful insights for fostering responsible AI applications and avoiding further negative impacts in higher education. To promote the fair and just use of AI, multidisciplinary academic teams should test the reliability of AI systems regardless of their intended use. It is essential to identify the potential positive and negative impacts of each AI application, particularly on early career researchers, and for multiple stakeholders in the research system to exercise their agency when deciding